Peter Stenger

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Education

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

Master of Computer Science — *August 2024 – May 2025*

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science — *August 2021 – May 2024*

Experience

Senior Software Engineer — November 2026 – Present

Google DeepMind — *Mountain View, CA*

Software Engineer — *August 2026 – November 2026*

Software Engineer — June 2026 – August 2026

Mechanize — *San Francisco, CA*

- Built RL environments and evals for frontier labs (similar to this).

Founding Engineer — June 2025 – June 2026

PrairieLearn — *Remote*

- Designed, planned, and built the full frontend and backend for the enrollment management, course publishing system, assessment access control system. Infrastructure work on AWS with Terraform.
- Modernized codebase to TypeScript, typed SQL queries (Zod), React, tRPC, react-aria, and TanStack Query/Table. Built a parser, linter and LSP for the mustache templating engine.

Security Research Intern — May 2024 – August 2024

Battelle — *Columbus, OH*

- Reverse-engineered MIPS & ARM firmware on embedded Linux devices, gaining an in-depth understanding of consumer device RF protocols. Discovered a means of running a version-agnostic binary using C and assembly.
- Added a caching layer to our distributed job runner (Kubernetes and MinIO) making job runs 95% faster.

Software Engineering Intern — May 2023 – August 2023

NETSCOUT — *Ann Arbor, MI*

- Modernized the account management page from pure PHP to React+MaterialUI, PHP, Python, Typescript.
- Fixed high-severity bugs in the PHP and React frontend, authorization issues in Python middleware, and filesystem issues in the custom operating system (bash + TCL).

Security Research Intern — May 2022 – August 2022

Battelle — *Columbus, OH*

- Reverse-engineered a ARM-based modem and modified functionality in order to exfiltrate valuable cellular data.
- Reverse-engineered a complex .NET modem debugging tool, and emulated the tool with 3000+ lines of Python.

Activities

Teaching Assistant (Distributed Systems, Intro to C++) — August 2024 – May 2025

SIGPwny — September 2021 – August 2024

- President of SIGPwny, a cybersecurity club with 150+ members and top-50 worldwide ranking on CTFtime.
- Project manager for UIUCTF 2023, which had 800+ teams (6k+ prize pool). Created a custom Windows 95 theme, wrote reverse-engineering and sandboxing challenges, stood up infrastructure on Google Cloud.

Security Research — September 2021 – May 2024

- Same-process sandboxing (2021), security education (2023), kernel configuration recovery (2024) under Levchenko.

Hack4Impact Developer — September 2022 – July 2023

- **Meraki (Spring 2023)** - Architected Parivartan, a tool to view insights into the state of Anganwadis (preschools) across India. Built with PostgreSQL, Typescript, tRPC, ChakraUI, Prisma, Supabase, AppScript.
- Designed the database schema and score caching system for 100,000+ form responses. Created a system that maps Google Forms to database tables, and performs schema migrations as forms change.

Awards & Skills

Eagle Scout, Dean's List · Python, Javascript (TypeScript/React), Rust, C, Golang, SQL · Git, Docker, AWS, CI